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System to minimize effects of ground plane noise

Abstract

A system to minimize effects of ground plane noise, including a processing unit including a first transmitter, a first receiver, and a first transistor, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the first receiver, the first transistor associated with a first ground voltage; and a memory device including a second transmitter, a second receiver, and a second transistor, wherein the second transistor is coupled to the second receiver, the second transistor associated with a second ground voltage; wherein the processing unit is coupled to the memory device, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the second transistor, wherein, when the processing unit is transmitting data to the memory device, the processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that a second threshold voltage associated with the second receiver is adjusted based on the first ground voltage.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

Field of the Disclosure

(1) The disclosure relates generally to a system to minimize effects of ground plane noise.

Description of the Related Art

(2) As the value and use of information continues to increase, individuals and businesses seek additional ways to process and store information. One option available to users is information handling systems. An information handling system generally processes, compiles, stores, and/or communicates information or data for business, personal, or other purposes, thereby allowing users to take advantage of the value of the information. Because technology and information handling needs and requirements vary between different users or applications, information handling systems may also vary regarding what information is handled, how the information is handled, how much information is processed, stored, or communicated, and how quickly and efficiently the information may be processed, stored, or communicated. The variations in information handling systems allow for information handling systems to be general or configured for a specific user or specific use such as financial transaction processing, airline reservations, enterprise data storage, or global communications. In addition, information handling systems may include a variety of hardware and software components that may be configured to process, store, and communicate information and may include one or more computer systems, data storage systems, and networking systems.

(3) Differential signaling is the preferred choice of transferring high speed data due to its common mode noise rejection properties. However, not all high-speed busses are differential. A memory bus

can use single ended signaling, making it susceptible to noise from various sources.

SUMMARY

(4) Innovative aspects of the subject matter described in this specification may be embodied in a system of a system to minimize effects of ground plane noise, including a processing unit including a first transmitter, a first receiver, and a first transistor, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the first receiver, the first transistor associated with a first ground voltage; and a memory device including a second transmitter, a second receiver, and a second transistor, wherein the second transistor is coupled to the second receiver, the second transistor associated with a second ground voltage; wherein the processing unit is coupled to the memory device, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the second transistor, wherein, when the processing unit is transmitting data to the memory device, the processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that a second threshold voltage associated with the second receiver is adjusted based on the first ground voltage.

(5) Other embodiments of these aspects include corresponding methods and apparatus.

(6) These and other embodiments may each optionally include one or more of the following features. For instance, an output of the first transmitter and an input of the first receiver is coupled to an output of the second transmitter and an input of the second receiver. The first transistor is associated with the first ground voltage at a first location of a ground plane, and the second transistor is associated with the second ground voltage at the second location of the ground plane. The first transistor is coupled to the second transistor via a ground compensation trace. The ground compensation trace is an existing trace. The processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that the first ground voltage associated with the first receiver is added to the second threshold voltage associated with the second receiver. The processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage and the second ground voltage is negated. When the memory device is transmitting data to the processing unit, the processing unit disables the first transistor and the memory device enables the second transistor such that a first threshold voltage associated with the first receiver is adjusted based on the second ground voltage.

(7) The details of one or more embodiments of the subject matter described in this specification are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other potential features, aspects, and advantages of the subject matter will become apparent from the description, the drawings, and the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of selected elements of an embodiment of an information handling system.

(2) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of an information handling system to minimize effects of ground plane noise, in a first implementation.

(3) FIG. 3 illustrates a block diagram of a processing unit and memory device of the information handling system.

(4) FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram of an information handling system to minimize effects of ground plane noise, in a second implementation.

DESCRIPTION OF PARTICULAR EMBODIMENT(S)

(5) This disclosure discusses a system to minimize effects of ground plane noise. In short, voltage drops (static and dynamic) can occur at a motherboard—i.e., a power supply can cease to provide power to the motherboard. For example, a power supply can have a failure, the power cord becomes unplugged from the information handling system, or the power supply becomes missing.

When a power supply (of multiple power supplies) ceases to provide power to the motherboard, there is a voltage gradient along the ground plane of the motherboard. As a result, there is ground voltage drop along the motherboard.

(6) Specifically, this disclosure discusses a system for minimizing effects of ground plane noise, including a processing unit including a first transmitter, a first receiver, and a first transistor, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the first receiver, the first transistor associated with a first ground voltage; and a memory device including a second transmitter, a second receiver, and a second transistor, wherein the second transistor is coupled to the second receiver, the second transistor associated with a second ground voltage; wherein the processing unit is coupled to the memory device, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the second transistor, wherein, when the processing unit is transmitting data to the memory device, the processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that a second threshold voltage associated with the second receiver is adjusted based on the first ground voltage.

(7) In the following description, details are set forth by way of example to facilitate discussion of the disclosed subject matter. It should be apparent to a person of ordinary skill in the field, however, that the disclosed embodiments are exemplary and not exhaustive of all possible embodiments.

(8) For the purposes of this disclosure, an information handling system may include an instrumentality or aggregate of instrumentalities operable to compute, classify, process, transmit, receive, retrieve, originate, switch, store, display, manifest, detect, record, reproduce, handle, or utilize various forms of information, intelligence, or data for business, scientific, control, entertainment, or other purposes. For example, an information handling system may be a personal computer, a PDA, a consumer electronic device, a network storage device, or another suitable device and may vary in size, shape, performance, functionality, and price. The information handling system may include memory, one or more processing resources such as a central processing unit (CPU) or hardware or software control logic. Additional components of the information handling system may include one or more storage devices, one or more communications ports for communicating with external devices as well as various input and output (I/O) devices, such as a keyboard, a mouse, and a video display. The information handling system may also include one or more buses operable to transmit communication between the various hardware components.

(9) For the purposes of this disclosure, computer-readable media may include an instrumentality or aggregation of instrumentalities that may retain data and/or instructions for a period of time. Computer-readable media may include, without limitation, storage media such as a direct access storage device (e.g., a hard disk drive or floppy disk), a sequential access storage device (e.g., a tape disk drive), compact disk, CD-ROM, DVD, random access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), and/or flash memory (SSD); as well as communications media such as wires, optical fibers, microwaves, radio waves, and other electromagnetic and/or optical carriers; and/or any combination of the foregoing.

(10) Particular embodiments are best understood by reference to FIGS. 1-4 wherein like numbers are used to indicate like and corresponding parts.

(11) Turning now to the drawings, FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram depicting selected elements of an information handling system **100** in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. In various embodiments, information handling system **100** may represent different types of portable information handling systems, such as, display devices, head mounted displays, head mount display systems, smart phones, tablet computers, notebook computers, media players, digital cameras, 2-in-1 tablet-laptop combination computers, and wireless organizers, or other types of portable information handling systems. In one or more embodiments, information handling system **100** may also represent other types of information handling systems, including desktop computers, server systems, controllers, and microcontroller units, among other types of information handling

systems. Components of information handling system **100** may include, but are not limited to, a processor subsystem **120**, which may comprise one or more processors, and system bus **121** that communicatively couples various system components to processor subsystem **120** including, for example, a memory subsystem **130**, an I/O subsystem **140**, a local storage resource **150**, and a network interface **160**. System bus **121** may represent a variety of suitable types of bus structures, e.g., a memory bus, a peripheral bus, or a local bus using various bus architectures in selected embodiments. For example, such architectures may include, but are not limited to, Micro Channel Architecture (MCA) bus, Industry Standard Architecture (ISA) bus, Enhanced ISA (EISA) bus, Peripheral Component Interconnect (PCI) bus, PCI-Express bus, HyperTransport (HT) bus, and Video Electronics Standards Association (VESA) local bus.

(12) As depicted in FIG. **1**, processor subsystem **120** may comprise a system, device, or apparatus operable to interpret and/or execute program instructions and/or process data, and may include one or more processing resources such as a central processing unit (CPU), microprocessor, microcontroller, digital signal processor (DSP), application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or another digital or analog circuitry configured to interpret and/or execute program instructions and/or process data. In some embodiments, processor subsystem **120** may interpret and/or execute program instructions and/or process data stored locally (e.g., in memory subsystem **130** and/or another component of information handling system). In the same or alternative embodiments, processor subsystem **120** may interpret and/or execute program instructions and/or process data stored remotely (e.g., in network storage resource **170**).

(13) Also in FIG. **1**, memory subsystem **130** may comprise a system, device, or apparatus operable to retain and/or retrieve program instructions and/or data for a period of time (e.g., computer-readable media). Memory subsystem **130** may comprise random access memory (RAM), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), a PCMCIA card, flash memory, magnetic storage, opto-magnetic storage, and/or a suitable selection and/or array of volatile or non-volatile memory that retains data after power to its associated information handling system, such as system **100**, is powered down.

(14) In information handling system **100**, I/O subsystem **140** may comprise a system, device, or apparatus generally operable to receive and/or transmit data to/from/within information handling system **100**. I/O subsystem **140** may represent, for example, a variety of communication interfaces, graphics interfaces, video interfaces, user input interfaces, and/or peripheral interfaces. In various embodiments, I/O subsystem **140** may be used to support various peripheral devices, such as a touch panel, a display adapter, a keyboard, an accelerometer, a touch pad, a gyroscope, an IR sensor, a microphone, a sensor, or a camera, or another type of peripheral device.

(15) Local storage resource **150** may comprise computer-readable media (e.g., hard disk drive, floppy disk drive, CD-ROM, and/or other types of rotating storage media, flash memory, EEPROM, and/or another type of solid state storage media) and may be generally operable to store instructions and/or data. Likewise, the network storage resource may comprise computer-readable media (e.g., hard disk drive, floppy disk drive, CD-ROM, and/or other types of rotating storage media, flash memory, EEPROM, and/or other types of solid state storage media) and may be generally operable to store instructions and/or data.

(16) In FIG. **1**, network interface **160** may be a suitable system, apparatus, or device operable to serve as an interface between information handling system **100** and a network **110**. Network interface **160** may enable information handling system **100** to communicate over network **110** using a suitable transmission protocol and/or standard, including, but not limited to, transmission protocols and/or standards enumerated below with respect to the discussion of network **110**. In some embodiments, network interface **160** may be communicatively coupled via network **110** to a network storage resource **170**. Network **110** may be a public network or a private (e.g., corporate) network. The network may be implemented as, or may be a part of, a storage area network (SAN), personal area network (PAN), local area network (LAN), a metropolitan area network (MAN), a

wide area network (WAN), a wireless local area network (WLAN), a virtual private network (VPN), an intranet, the Internet or another appropriate architecture or system that facilitates the communication of signals, data and/or messages (generally referred to as data). Network interface **160** may enable wired and/or wireless communications (e.g., NFC or Bluetooth) to and/or from information handling system **100**.

(17) In particular embodiments, network **110** may include one or more routers for routing data between client information handling systems **100** and server information handling systems **100**. A device (e.g., a client information handling system **100** or a server information handling system **100**) on network **110** may be addressed by a corresponding network address including, for example, an Internet protocol (IP) address, an Internet name, a Windows Internet name service (WINS) name, a domain name or other system name. In particular embodiments, network **110** may include one or more logical groupings of network devices such as, for example, one or more sites (e.g., customer sites) or subnets. As an example, a corporate network may include potentially thousands of offices or branches, each with its own subnet (or multiple subnets) having many devices. One or more client information handling systems **100** may communicate with one or more server information handling systems **100** via any suitable connection including, for example, a modem connection, a LAN connection including the Ethernet, or a broadband WAN connection including DSL, Cable, Ti, T3, Fiber Optics, Wi-Fi, or a mobile network connection including GSM, GPRS, 3G, or WiMax.

(18) Network **110** may transmit data using a desired storage and/or communication protocol, including, but not limited to, Fibre Channel, Frame Relay, Asynchronous Transfer Mode (ATM), Internet protocol (IP), other packet-based protocol, small computer system interface (SCSI), Internet SCSI (iSCSI), Serial Attached SCSI (SAS) or another transport that operates with the SCSI protocol, advanced technology attachment (ATA), serial ATA (SATA), advanced technology attachment packet interface (ATAPI), serial storage architecture (SSA), integrated drive electronics (IDE), and/or any combination thereof. Network **110** and its various components may be implemented using hardware, software, or any combination thereof.

(19) Turning to FIG. 2, FIG. 2 illustrates an environment **200** including an information handling system **202**. The information handling system **202** can include a power supply **204**, a power supply **206**, and a motherboard **208**. In some examples, the information handling system **202** is similar to, or includes, the information handling system **100** of FIG. 1.

(20) The motherboard **208** can include a processing unit **210** and a memory device **212**. The processing unit **210** can be in communication with the memory device **212**.

(21) The processing unit **210** can include a first transmitter **214**, a first receiver **216**, and a first transistor **218**. The first transistor **218** can be a field-effect transistor (FET). In some examples, the processing unit **210** is a central processing unit (CPU). In some examples, the processing unit **210** is the same, or substantially the same, as the processor subsystem **120** of FIG. 1.

(22) The memory device **212** can include a second transmitter **224**, a second receiver **226**, and a second transistor **228**. The second transistor **228** can be a field-effect transistor (FET). In some examples, the memory device **212** is a dual in-line memory module (DIMM). In some examples, the memory device **212** is the same, or substantially the same, as the memory subsystem **130** of FIG. 1. The power supplies **204** and **206** can provide power to the motherboard **208**.

(23) In short, voltage drops (static and dynamic) can occur at the motherboard **208**. Specifically, one of the power supplies **204**, **206** can cease to provide power to the motherboard **208**. For example, one of the power supplies **204**, **206** can have a failure, have the power cord unplugged from the information handling system **202**, or one of the power supplies **204**, **206** becomes missing. For example, the power supply **206** ceases to provide power to the motherboard **208**. When the power supply **206** ceases to provide power to the motherboard **208**, there is a voltage gradient along the ground plane of the motherboard **208**. For example, when only the power supply **204** is providing power to the motherboard **208**, power is provided generally along the direction D1, and

the return ground current can travel along the direction D2, opposite to the direction D1. As a result, there is a ground voltage drop at the motherboard **208**. That is, there is a different voltage at the processing unit **210** as compared to the voltage at the memory device **212**, detailed further herein.

(24) FIG. 3 illustrates a system **300** to minimize the effects of ground plane noise. The processing unit **210** can include the first transmitter **214**, the first receiver **216**, and the first transistor **218**. The first transmitter **214** is coupled to the first receiver **216**. The first transistor **218** is coupled to the first receiver **216**. The first transistor **218** is associated with a first ground voltage. For example, the first ground voltage is a voltage of the ground plane at a location proximate to the processing unit **210** physically on the motherboard **208**. That is, the first transistor **218** is associated with the first ground voltage at a first location of the ground plane.

(25) Furthermore, the memory device **212** can include the second transmitter **224**, the second receiver **226**, and the second transistor **228**. The second transmitter **224** is coupled to the second receiver **226**. The second transistor **228** is coupled to the second receiver **226**. The second transistor **228** is associated with a second ground voltage. For example, the second ground voltage is a voltage of the ground plane at a second location proximate to the memory device **212** physically on the motherboard **208**. That is, the second transistor **228** is associated with the second ground voltage at a second location of the ground plane.

(26) The processing unit **210** is coupled to the memory device **212**. Specifically, the output of the first transmitter **214** is coupled to the input of the first receiver **216**; and the output of the second transmitter **224** is coupled to the input of the second receiver **226**. Furthermore, the output of the first transmitter **214** and the input of the first receiver **216** is coupled to the output of the second transmitter **224** and the input of the second receiver **226**, shown by communication channel **310**. Thus, the processing unit **210** is in communication with the memory device **212**; and the processing unit **210** is coupled to the memory device **212**.

(27) The first transistor **218** is coupled to the second transistor **228**. Specifically, the first transistor **218** is coupled to the second transistor **228** via a ground compensation trace **302**. In some examples, the ground compensation trace **302** is an existing trace of the motherboard **208**. For example, the ground compensation trace **302** can include a ground compensation signal that is an additional pin, or one of the existing bidirectional signals that can be reused of the motherboard **208**. For example, serial data (SDA) that is normally used as serial presence detect (SPD) data can be used as ground compensation during communication (transactions) between the processing unit **210** and the memory device **212**.

(28) To that end, the processing unit **210** can transmit data to the memory device **212** over the communication channel **310**. For example, the processing unit **210** is “writing” data to the memory device **212**. When the processing unit **210** is transmitting data to the memory device **212**, the processing unit **210** enables the first transistor **218** and the memory device **212** disables the second transistor **228**. As a result, the ground compensation trace **302** has the ground potential of the processing unit **210** at the first transistor **218** (e.g., a “copy” of the ground voltage at the processing unit **210**). By having the ground compensation trace **302** have the ground voltage of the processing unit **210** at the first transistor **218**, a second threshold voltage associated with the memory device **212** can be adjusted. Specifically, the second threshold voltage associated with the memory device **212**, and in particular, the second receiver **216**, can be adjusted based on the first ground voltage that is associated with the processing unit **210**, and in particular, the first transistor **218**.

(29) In some examples, the processing unit **210** enables the first transistor **218** and the memory device **212** disables the second transistor **228** such that the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **210** is added to the second threshold voltage associated with the memory device **212**. Specifically, the processing unit **210** enables the first transistor **218** and the memory device **212** disables the second transistor **228** such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **210** and the second ground voltage associated with the

memory device **212** is negated, or compensated for. Thus, the ground offset and noise of the ground plane associated with the motherboard **208** is cancelled (or effectively cancelled).

(30) For example, the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **212** is 10 mV higher than the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **210**. Thus, the second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **212** needs to be lowered by 10 mV. The processing unit **210** enables the first transistor **218**. The memory device **212** disables the second transistor **228**, and adds the voltage of the ground compensation trace **302** (−10 mV from the point of view of the second transistor **228**) to the second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **212**, effectively cancelling the ground voltage difference.

(31) In some further embodiments, the memory device **212** can transmit data to the processing unit **210** over the communication channel **310**. For example, the memory device **212** is providing data to the processing unit **210** (the processing unit **210** is “reading” data from the memory device **212**). When the memory device **212** is transmitting data to the processing unit **210**, the processing unit **210** disables the first transistor **218** and the memory device **212** enables the second transistor **228**. As a result, the ground compensation trace **302** has the ground potential of the memory device **212** at the second transistor **228** (e.g., a “copy” of the ground voltage at the memory device **212**). By having the ground compensation trace **302** have the ground voltage of the memory device **212** at the second transistor **228**, the first threshold voltage associated with the processing unit **210** can be adjusted. Specifically, the first threshold voltage associated with the processing unit **210**, and in particular, the first receiver **126**, can be adjusted based on the second ground voltage that is associated with the memory device **212**, and in particular, the second transistor **228**.

(32) In some examples, the memory device **212** enables the second transistor **228** and the processing unit **210** disables the first transistor **218** such that the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **212** is added to the first threshold voltage associated with the processing unit **210**. Specifically, the processing unit **210** disables the first transistor **218** and the memory device **212** enables the second transistor **228** such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **210** and the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **212** is negated, or compensated for. Thus, the ground offset and noise of the ground plane associated with the motherboard **208** is cancelled (or effectively cancelled).

(33) For example, the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **210** is 10 mV lower than the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **212**. Thus, the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **210** needs to be raised by 10 mV. The memory device **212** enables the second transistor **228**. The processing unit **210** disables the first transistor **218**, and adds the voltage of the ground compensation trace **302** (10 mV from the point of view of the first transistor **218**) to the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **210**, effectively cancelling the ground voltage difference.

(34) Turning to FIG. 4, FIG. 4 illustrates an environment **500** including an information handling system **502**. The information handling system **502** can include a power supply **504**, a power supply **506**, and a motherboard **508**. In some examples, the information handling system **502** is similar to, or includes, the information handling system **100** of FIG. 1.

(35) The motherboard **508** can include a processing unit **510**, a first memory device **512**, a second memory device **513**, a management computing module **515**, and an analog to digital converter (ADC) **517**. The processing unit **510** can be in communication with the memory devices **512**, **513**.

(36) In some examples, the processing unit **510** is a central processing unit (CPU). In some examples, the processing unit **510** is the same, or substantially the same, as the processor subsystem **120** of FIG. 1.

(37) In some examples, the memory device **512** is a dual in-line memory module (DIMM). In some examples, the memory device **512** is the same, or substantially the same, as the memory subsystem **130** of FIG. 1. In some examples, the memory device **513** is a dual in-line memory module (DIMM). In some examples, the memory device **513** is the same, or substantially the same, as the

memory subsystem **130** of FIG. **1**. The power supplies **504** and **506** can provide power to the motherboard **508**.

(38) In some examples, the management computing module **515** is included by an embedded controller (EC) of the information handling system **502**. In some examples, the management computing module **515** is included by a baseband management controller (BMC) of the information handling system **502**.

(39) The ADC **517** is in communication with the processing unit **510**, the memory device **512**, the memory device **513**, and the management computing module **515**.

(40) In short, voltage drops (static and dynamic) can occur at the motherboard **508**. Specifically, one of the power supplies **504**, **506** can cease to provide power to the motherboard **508**. For example, one of the power supplies **504**, **506** can have a failure, have the power cord unplugged from the information handling system **502**, or one of the power supplies **504**, **506** becomes missing. For example, the power supply **506** ceases to provide power to the motherboard **508**. When the power supply **506** ceases to provide power to the motherboard **508**, there is a voltage gradient along the ground plane of the motherboard **508**. For example, when only power supply **504** is providing power to the motherboard **508**, power is provided generally along the direction **D1**, and the return ground current can travel along the direction **D2**, opposite to the direction **D1**. As a result, there is ground voltage drop at the motherboard **508**. That is, there is a different voltage at the processing unit **510** as compared to the voltage at the memory device **512**, detailed further herein.

(41) The ADC **517** is configured to determine a first ground voltage at the processing unit **510** and a second ground voltage at the memory device **512**. For example, the first ground voltage and the second ground voltage can both be static. The ADC **517** measures the first ground voltage at a first location proximate to the processing unit **510** and the second ground voltage at a second location proximate to the memory device **512**. For example, the ADC **517** measures the first ground voltage near pins of the processing unit **510** and measures the second ground voltage near pins of the memory device **512**. In some examples, if the ground return current is not predominantly perpendicular to the memory device **512**, the ADC **517** can measure the second ground voltage at several test points proximate to the memory device **512**.

(42) For example, the ADC **517** measures the first ground voltage at the processing unit **510** as 10 mV; and the second ground voltage at the memory device **512** as 20 mV.

(43) The management computing module **515** is configured to calculate a voltage delta between the first ground voltage at the processing unit **510** and the second ground voltage at the memory device **512**. The management computing module **515** adjusts, based on the voltage delta, a first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510**. That is, the management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** to compensate for voltage drops in the ground plane of the motherboard **508**.

(44) In some examples, the management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** such that the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **512** is added to the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510**. Specifically, the management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510** and the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **512** is negated, or compensated for. Thus, the ground offset and noise of the ground plane associated with the motherboard **508** is cancelled (or effectively cancelled).

(45) For example, the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510** is 10 mV lower than the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **512**. Thus, the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** needs to be raised by 10 mV for memory reads; and the second voltage threshold associated with memory device **512** needs to be lowered by 10 mV for memory writes. The management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold

associated with the processing unit **510** to add 10 mV to the first voltage threshold, and adjusts the second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** to subtract 10 mV to the second voltage threshold.

(46) In some examples, the management computing module **515** adjusts a second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** such that the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510** is added to the second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512**. Specifically, the management computing module **515** adjusts the second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510** and the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **512** is negated, or compensated for. Thus, the ground offset and noise of the ground plane associated with the motherboard **508** is cancelled (or effectively cancelled).

(47) For example, the second ground voltage associated with the memory device **512** is 10 mV higher than the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510**. Thus, the second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** needs to be lowered by 10 mV for memory writes; and the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** needs to be raised by 10 mV for memory reads. The management computing module **515** adjusts the second voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** to lower the second voltage threshold by 10 mV, and adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** to add 10 mV to the first voltage threshold.

(48) In some implementations, the ADC **517** is further configured to determine a third ground voltage at the memory device **512**. For example, the third ground voltage can be static. The ADC **517** measures the third ground voltage at a third location proximate to the memory device **513**. For example, the ADC **517** measures the third ground voltage near pins of the memory device **513**. In some examples, if the ground return current is not predominantly perpendicular to the memory device **513**, the ADC **517** can measure the third ground voltage at several test points proximate to the memory device **513**.

(49) The management computing module **515** is configured to calculate an additional voltage delta between the first ground voltage at the processing unit **510** and the third ground voltage at the memory device **513**. The management computing module **515** adjusts, based on the additional voltage delta, the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510**. That is, the management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** to compensate for voltage drops in the ground plane of the motherboard **508**.

(50) In some examples, the management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** such that the third ground voltage associated with the memory device **513** is added to the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510**. Specifically, the management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510** and the third ground voltage associated with the memory device **513** is negated, or compensated for. Thus, the ground offset and noise of the ground plane associated with the motherboard **508** is cancelled (or effectively cancelled).

(51) For example, the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510** is 20 mV lower than the third ground voltage associated with the memory device **213**. Thus, the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **210** needs to be raised by 20 mV for memory reads. The management computing module **515** adjusts the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit **510** to add 20 mV to the first voltage threshold.

(52) In some examples, the management computing module **515** adjusts a third voltage threshold associated with the memory device **513** such that the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510** is added to the third voltage threshold associated with the memory device **514**. Specifically, the management computing module **515** adjusts the third voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage

associated with the processing unit **510** and the third ground voltage associated with the memory device **513** is negated, or compensated for. Thus, the ground offset and noise of the ground plane associated with the motherboard **508** is cancelled (or effectively cancelled).

(53) For example, the third ground voltage associated with the memory device **513** is 20 mV higher than the first ground voltage associated with the processing unit **510**. Thus, the third voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** needs to be lowered by 20 mV for memory writes. The management computing module **515** adjusts the third voltage threshold associated with the memory device **512** to lower the second voltage threshold by 20 mV.

(54) The above disclosed subject matter is to be considered illustrative, and not restrictive, and the appended claims are intended to cover all such modifications, enhancements, and other embodiments which fall within the true spirit and scope of the present disclosure. Thus, to the maximum extent allowed by law, the scope of the present disclosure is to be determined by the broadest permissible interpretation of the following claims and their equivalents, and shall not be restricted or limited by the foregoing detailed description.

(55) Herein, “or” is inclusive and not exclusive, unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context. Therefore, herein, “A or B” means “A, B, or both,” unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context. Moreover, “and” is both joint and several, unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context. Therefore, herein, “A and B” means “A and B, jointly or severally,” unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context.

(56) The scope of this disclosure encompasses all changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and modifications to the example embodiments described or illustrated herein that a person having ordinary skill in the art would comprehend. The scope of this disclosure is not limited to the example embodiments described or illustrated herein. Moreover, although this disclosure describes and illustrates respective embodiments herein as including particular components, elements, features, functions, operations, or steps, any of these embodiments may include any combination or permutation of any of the components, elements, features, functions, operations, or steps described or illustrated anywhere herein that a person having ordinary skill in the art would comprehend. Furthermore, reference in the appended claims to an apparatus or system or a component of an apparatus or system being adapted to, arranged to, capable of, configured to, enabled to, operable to, or operative to perform a particular function encompasses that apparatus, system, component, whether or not it or that particular function is activated, turned on, or unlocked, as long as that apparatus, system, or component is so adapted, arranged, capable, configured, enabled, operable, or operative.

Claims

1. A system to minimize effects of ground plane noise, including: a processing unit including a first transmitter, a first receiver, and a first transistor, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the first receiver, the first transistor associated with a first ground voltage; and a memory device including a second transmitter, a second receiver, and a second transistor, wherein the second transistor is coupled to the second receiver, the second transistor associated with a second ground voltage; wherein the processing unit is coupled to the memory device, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the second transistor, wherein, when the processing unit is transmitting data to the memory device, the processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that a second threshold voltage associated with the second receiver is adjusted based on the first ground voltage.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein an output of the first transmitter and an input of the first receiver is coupled to an output of the second transmitter and an input of the second receiver.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the first transistor is associated with the first ground voltage at a

- first location of a ground plane, and the second transistor is associated with the second ground voltage at the second location of the ground plane.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the first transistor is coupled to the second transistor via a ground compensation trace.
 5. The system of claim 4, wherein the ground compensation trace is an existing trace.
 6. The system of claim 1, wherein the processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that the first ground voltage associated with the first receiver is added to the second threshold voltage associated with the second receiver.
 7. The system of claim 6, wherein the processing unit enables the first transistor and the memory device disables the second transistor such that a voltage difference between the first ground voltage and the second ground voltage is negated.
 8. The system of claim 1, wherein, when the memory device is transmitting data to the processing unit, the processing unit disables the first transistor and the memory device enables the second transistor such that a first threshold voltage associated with the first receiver is adjusted based on the second ground voltage.
 9. A system to minimize effects of ground plane noise, including: a processing unit; a memory device; an analog to digital converter (ADC) configured to determine a first ground voltage at the processing unit and a second ground voltage at the memory device; a management computing module configured to: calculate a voltage delta between the first ground voltage and the second ground voltage; and adjust, based on the voltage delta, a first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit.
 10. The system of claim 9, wherein the management computing module is further configured to adjust, based on the voltage data, a second voltage threshold associated with the memory device.
 11. The system of claim 9, further including: an additional memory device, wherein the ADC is further configured to determine a third ground voltage at the additional memory device, wherein the management computing module is further configured to: calculate an additional voltage delta between the first ground voltage and the third ground voltage; and adjust, based on the additional voltage delta, the first voltage threshold associated with the processing unit.
 12. The system of claim 11, wherein the management computing module is further configured to adjust, based on the additional voltage data, a third voltage threshold associated with the additional memory device.
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